

M-13 — Phishing & Social Engineering

What is this about?

How people get talked into handing over the password, the payment or the file — and the pause that stops it.

The idea, in plain terms

Rekha handles accounts payable in Gurugram. An email arrives from a regular supplier saying their bank details have changed. The signature, the logo and the invoice format are all correct. She updates the record and pays. One phone call to a number you already had. That is the whole defence.

Key things to know

- **URGENCY** — today, before close, immediately
- **AUTHORITY** — from a director, a bank, a regulator
- **SECRECY** — do not discuss this with the team yet
- **A CHANGE** — new bank details, new address, new process

A simple example

Situation: An email from a regular supplier says their bank details have changed and an overdue invoice needs paying today. The layout, logo and signature all look exactly right.

What to do: Ring the supplier on the number you already had on file.

Remember

- **They do not look wrong** — Perfect English, real logos, your order number. Spelling is not the test.
- **Four pressure signals** — Urgency, authority, secrecy, a change. One alone is reason enough to verify.
- **Verify outside the channel** — A number you already had, not one from the message.
- **Never a one-time code** — Nobody legitimate asks. There is genuinely no exception.
- **If you clicked, disconnect and report** — Leave it powered on, change the password elsewhere, report within the hour.

Inducto Learning & Knowledge — quick reference for M-13. Watch the lesson video for the full explanation; this page is a takeaway, not a replacement for it.